

height attributes will change rather than adding a transformation matrix for simple translating and scaling operations.

Paths

Paths are arbitrary shaped objects. Examples of paths are bezier curves and free-hand curves. In this chapter we first see some path terminologies and how paths are described in Inkscape, and then see how paths can be created, and finally how paths are edited.

Paths can be either open (have two ends) or closed (have no ends). They can also be compound (composed of separate open and / or closed paths).

Paths differ from shapes in that there is no predefined structure. For example, a rectangle shape is defined in terms of a width and height with an x and y offset. A corner point cannot be moved independently of at least another corner point. A path, in the shape of a rectangle, consists of the coordinates of the four corner points. A single corner point can be moved by itself with the resulting shape no longer rectangular. A regular shape can be converted into a path.

Filters

Filter effects are a feature of SVG that allow an SVG viewer to change the presentation of an object in a well-defined manner by adding texture to a fill, giving an object a blurred shadow, or modifying the object's colour. Inkscape supports the Gaussian Blur filter.

Inkscape can be enhanced by effects. These are scripts or programs that can be run from inside Inkscape. Most effects require external programs, usually written in Perl or Python.

4.4.2. Corel Draw

CorelDraw is another great vector image editing tool which is very popular. It not only has the basic features of skewing, flipping and rotating objects, but also a few others as well.